

Restaurant Closing Checklist

A detailed closing checklist that helps hospitality teams leave the venue clean, secure, compliant and ready for the next shift.

How to use this checklist

Use this checklist at the end of each service period. Closing is not just cleaning up. It is the handover to tomorrow.

The closing manager should complete each section, record exceptions, and sign off only when the venue is secure, cash has been checked, food is stored correctly, and the next shift has enough information to start well.

Closing manager details

Date:

Venue:

Closing manager:

Shift:

Scheduled close time:

Actual lock-up time:

Service type:

Weather or local conditions:

Front of house

- ☐ Tables and chairs are cleaned, reset and positioned correctly.
- ☐ Floors are swept, mopped or vacuumed as required.
- ☐ Menus are cleaned, counted and stored.
- ☐ Service stations are cleaned and restocked for the next shift.
- ☐ Bathrooms are cleaned, stocked and checked.
- ☐ Rubbish and recycling have been removed to the correct area.
- ☐ Lost property has been recorded and stored.
- ☐ Reservation notes and customer follow-ups have been updated.
- ☐ POS terminals and printers are closed down correctly.
- ☐ Guest areas have been checked for personal items.
- ☐ Outdoor areas are packed down, secured and clean.
- ☐ Signage has been brought inside or secured.

Front of house notes:

Kitchen

- ☐ Food is stored correctly.
- ☐ Labels and dates have been checked.
- ☐ Refrigeration temperatures are recorded.
- ☐ Freezer temperatures are recorded.
- ☐ Cooking equipment is turned off according to close-down procedure.
- ☐ Hot surfaces have been checked before leaving.
- ☐ Benches, sinks and prep areas are cleaned and sanitised.
- ☐ Floors are cleaned.
- ☐ Bins are emptied, cleaned where required and relined.
- ☐ Grease and waste have been handled correctly.
- ☐ Cleaning chemicals are stored safely.
- ☐ Dish area is clean and ready for the next shift.
- ☐ Pest risk areas have been checked.

Kitchen notes:

Bar and beverage

- ☐ Beverage stock is secured.
- ☐ Coffee machine is cleaned according to procedure.
- ☐ Grinder and coffee station are cleaned.
- ☐ Glassware is washed, polished and stored.
- ☐ Ice wells are emptied or covered according to venue policy.
- ☐ Bar fridges are stocked and closed.
- ☐ Garnishes are discarded or stored correctly.
- ☐ Bar tools are cleaned and stored.
- ☐ Tills and EFTPOS terminals are closed or secured.
- ☐ Water station and service areas are cleaned.

Bar and beverage notes:

Cash and administration

- ☐ Cash reconciliation is complete.
- ☐ EFTPOS reconciliation is complete.
- ☐ Refunds have been reviewed and recorded.
- ☐ Voids have been reviewed and explained.
- ☐ Discounts or comps have been checked.
- ☐ Cash discrepancies have been recorded.
- ☐ Daily sales summary has been completed.
- ☐ Banking or safe drop has been completed according to policy.
- ☐ Manager report has been sent or saved.

Cash or admin notes:

Stock and ordering

- ☐ Low stock items have been recorded.
- ☐ Urgent orders have been identified.
- ☐ Damaged stock has been recorded.
- ☐ Wastage has been recorded.
- ☐ Supplier issues have been noted.
- ☐ Items required for opening have been communicated.
- ☐ Critical shortages have been escalated.

Stock notes:

Team and shift review

- ☐ Attendance has been checked.
- ☐ Lateness, absences or shift changes have been recorded.
- ☐ Incidents have been documented.
- ☐ Customer complaints have been recorded and followed up.
- ☐ Positive feedback has been captured.
- ☐ Staff performance notes have been recorded where appropriate.
- ☐ Training needs have been identified.
- ☐ Any unresolved team issue has been escalated.

Team notes:

Security

- ☐ Windows are closed and locked.
- ☐ Internal doors are secured.
- ☐ External doors are locked.
- ☐ Alarm is set.
- ☐ Keys are accounted for.
- ☐ Safe is locked.
- ☐ External areas have been checked.
- ☐ Non-essential lights are off.
- ☐ Required security lighting remains on.
- ☐ No unauthorised people remain on site.

Security notes:

Maintenance issues

Record anything that needs repair, replacement or investigation.

Maintenance notes:

Cleaning or repair follow-up

Follow-up item	Owner	Priority	Due

End-of-shift review

What went well?

What needs attention tomorrow?

What must not be missed at opening?

Final lock-up and manager sign-off

The venue has been cleaned, secured and handed over for the next shift.

Closing manager signature:

Time signed off:

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